



June 3rd 2019 Delaware County Commissioners Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Weh10ZbwT48
Publication Date	2019-06-05T19:55:46Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Report

Meeting Date: June 3, 2019

Session Time: Called to order at 9:03 AM

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presided over by the Delaware County Commissioners. The meeting opened with a moment of remembrance dedicated to public servants affected by a recent tragedy in Virginia Beach, Virginia.
- **Attendance:**
 - *Present:* Commissioner King, Commissioner Henry, and Board President Sherry Reagan.
 - *Absent:* None noted in the transcript.

3. Procedural & Preliminary Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence and reflection honoring public servants in Virginia Beach.

- **Approval of Minutes:** *Not explicitly detailed or voted upon in the available transcript excerpt.*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:01:35 Presentation: Muncie Land Bank Startup Plan

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** John West (Assistant Professor of Urban Planning, Ball State University), joined by consultants Jim Rokakis and Gus Frangos (Thriving Communities / Cuyahoga County Land Bank), Robyn Thomas, and Lindsey Arthur (CEO, Muncie Habitat for Humanity).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Presenters outlined a comprehensive startup plan for the Muncie Land Bank, created under 2016 state legislation. The presenters emphasized that vacant and abandoned properties drive down neighboring property values, escalate crime, and increase fire hazards. They recommended establishing internal and external local collaborations (engaging the county auditor, county commissioners, city enforcement authorities, and local nonprofits like Habitat for Humanity) to create a predictable, systematic approach to clearing titles and returning tax-delinquent, abandoned properties to productive use. The Muncie Land Bank set a modest initial goal of handling four properties by the end of the year (two with structures for rehabilitation, two vacant lots for development or community use).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Lindsey Arthur, CEO of Muncie Habitat for Humanity, spoke in support of the land bank, noting that Habitat has been serving as an ad hoc land bank for local coalition efforts and burdened by securing properties due to a lack of staffing in smaller organizations.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation only; no formal vote taken. Commissioners requested copies of the Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) and board member lists.

00:22:26 Services Agreement: Freeman McIntyre Attorney Services

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Representative from Delaware County Economic Development / Freeman McIntyre.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Presented a professional services agreement for legal and economic development work. A minor administrative revision was noted, replacing a former commissioner's name on the signature line with current Board President Sherry Reagan.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (combined with Resolution 2019-H-021).

00:23:36 Resolution 2019-H-021: Approval of Freeman McIntyre Services Agreement

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Economic Development / County Attorney.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Formal resolution adopting the reviewed legal services contract.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:24:42 Ordinance 2019-20: Property Transfer Fee Increase

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Attorney / Staff.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Drafted at the request of the State Auditor to reflect a state legislative fee increase. Recording a deed and filing a sales disclosure form with the auditor increases from \$5.00 to \$10.00, effective July 1, 2019.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:24:48 Resolution 2019-22: Transfer of Properties to Nonprofits

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Staff / Board.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Initiates a formal process for certain nonprofits (including Cardinal Greenway) requesting properties via the deed sale process. The resolution schedules a public hearing for the next meeting to allow entities to present their cases to the commissioners.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:26:56 Jeff Stanley (Chief Deputy, Sheriff's Office):** Provided an administrative update regarding the upcoming fourth annual Sheriff's Summer Camp for youth ages 12 through 15, noting that approximately 100 student applicants are expected and the fairgrounds have made a building available.
- **00:28:28 Discussion on City EMS Transition & 9-1-1 Dispatch Impact:** Commissioners and 9-1-1 Director Paul Singleton engaged in an extended discussion regarding the City of Muncie's plans to introduce basic life support (BLS) ambulances. Officials expressed concern over the lack of a formal plan presented to county emergency directors, the significant labor-intensive database and Computer-Aided Dispatch (CAD) re-mapping required for 9-1-1 address protocols, and potential resource duplication. Commissioners directed the county attorney to draft a formal letter to the mayor and fire chief requesting the city's operational plan.
- **00:45:18 Ron (County Council Representative):** Spoke on behalf of the County Council, expressing support for the commissioners' positions on public safety and budgeting. He noted that county operations would have been in a stronger position fiscally if the city had paid past-due fees owed to the council, and reminded departments to submit 2020 budgets under the assumption of status quo, pending adjustments.

- **00:47:43 Commissioner Discussion / Proposal for County Engineer Staffing:** A commissioner raised a proposal to explore hiring an in-house county engineer or maintenance specialist to assist with infrastructure maintenance, bridge assessments (noting 193 bridges and extensive drainage ditches), and county building upkeep to reduce reliance on external consultants.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Public hearing scheduled for the next meeting regarding nonprofit property transfers.
 - Upcoming meetings and city council sessions regarding EMS and land bank funding.
 - Claims approved in the amount of **\$1,277,056.67** **00:56:24**.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting concluded following claims approval and public remarks **00:57:08**.
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